

or generating higher economic output while consuming less energy. According to Jha, the firm is looking to double energy productivity from its 2019 baseline by 2030.

Alongside, ABB has also committed to an initiative to operate on 100% renewable electricity. The company says it has already achieved this target across its operations, as disclosed in its Business Responsibility and Sustainability Reporting (BRSR) filing.

However, it acknowledges that sustainability investments are increasingly being scrutinised through a commercial lens. Jha notes that return on investment remains a key factor in evaluating several initiatives, particularly renewable energy adoption, where payback often takes four–five years.

“A similar approach is being adopted for energy-efficiency measures. As part of this, ABB is upgrading motors across facilities to more energy-efficient ones to improve operational efficiency and lower energy consumption,” Jha adds.

The company’s sustainability push also extends to customer-facing technologies. ABB says its electrification and automation solutions are helping industries reduce energy consumption and greenhouse gas emissions. The company’s recently launched i6 motors, for instance, are designed to improve energy efficiency while reducing dependence on rare earth materials, thereby strengthening supply-chain resilience.

The second pillar of ABB’s strategy focuses on preserving resources through circularity, waste reduction and water stewardship. Nearly 70% of its sites are now certified zero waste to landfill, while around 15% of its products undergo life-cycle assessments to better under-

stand their environmental impact and improve product circularity.

It recently secured certification under the Alliance for Water Stewardship framework, a global standard focused on sustainable water management involving factories, suppliers and communities.

The third pillar centres around social progress. This includes employee health and safety, supplier engagement, diversity initiatives and community development programmes. ABB says it has undertaken groundwater restoration initiatives across nearly 70 villages, alongside education and diversity-focused programs in communities around its operations.

Supplier engagement, particularly among MSMEs, is increasingly becoming a critical part of the company’s sustainability agenda as firms attempt to meet stricter emission reduction mandates. ABB says it has engaged suppliers accounting for nearly 51% of its procurement spend as part of its sustainability and ESG initiatives.

According to Jha, all of ABB India’s factories are now certified as platinum-rated Indian green buildings—the highest level under the certification framework of the Indian Green Building Council. The company also says it has reduced greenhouse gas emissions by nearly 86% from its baseline levels and is targeting a 100% reduction by 2030.

As sustainability conversations evolve from compliance-driven mandates to long-term industrial transformation, companies like ABB are increasingly positioning sustainability as a core business and operational strategy tied to efficiency, resilience and future competitiveness. **BT**

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MOST SUSTAINABLE COMPANY IN MANUFACTURING (CAPITAL GOODS)

ABB India is moving beyond ESG compliance and embedding sustainability into operations, supply chains, customer solutions and long-term industrial strategy

The company’s road map is built around three pillars—enabling a low-carbon society, preserving resources, and driving social progress

It uses 100% renewable electricity across operations and is pursuing a target of doubling energy productivity by 2030

ABB is increasingly focusing on supplier ESG engagement, MSME handholding, water-positive operations

